

Lab 2.1: Conduct a Mini-Market Analysis

Introduction

This hands-on lab gives you practice turning market research into a sales decision. You will analyze a specific market segment, identify a few key insights from the information provided, and propose one concrete sales play. The goal is to practice the full path from research to action, not just gathering facts, but deciding what to do with them.

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Analyze a market segment using provided research.
- Identify three actionable insights from market information.
- Describe a specific sales play based on insights.



Scenario

You are a sales strategist at PayPro Solutions, which provides payroll, HR compliance, and employee benefits administration. Leadership wants to grow in the small business segment (companies with 50 to 200 employees) in your region. Your job is to analyze this segment and recommend one focused sales play.

You have gathered the following research about the segment:

Companies in this size range are large enough to find in-house payroll burdensome, but often too small to have a dedicated payroll specialist. Payroll is frequently handled by an office manager or a finance generalist alongside performing other duties.

Industry surveys show that compliance, keeping up with changing tax and labor regulations, is the top payroll-related concern for businesses in this range, ahead of cost.

Many of these companies are growing and hiring, which makes their payroll and benefits needs more complex over time.

Several competitors target either very small businesses (under 50 employees) or large enterprises, leaving the middle segment less directly served.

Switching providers is seen as risky and disruptive, so these companies tend to stay with a provider once they choose one.

Tools/Downloadable Resources:

Lab 2.1 Exemplar Solution (DOCX)

Activity Steps

Exercise 1: Identify Three Key Insights

Objective: Turn the research into clear and actionable insights.

Step 1: Review the research

Read through the five research points in the scenario. Look for what each one means for how PayPro could sell to this segment.

Step 2: Write three insights

Write three short and insightful statements. An insight is not just a fact; it is what the fact means for your selling. For example, do not simply restate that compliance is the top concern. State what that implies for how PayPro should position itself.

Exercise 2: Propose One Sales Play

Objective: Turn your insights into a single and concrete action.

Step 1: Choose your focus

Based on your three insights, decide on one specific sales play. A sales play is a focused action. For example, it may include a segment to target, a message to lead with, or an offer to build. Choose one, do not list several.

Step 2: Justify the sales play

In two or three sentences, explain why this play fits the segment, drawing on your insights. A strong play connects directly to what the research already shows.

Self-Assessment Checklist

By the end of this lab, you should have a brief report that includes:

- Three insight statements that interpret the research, not just restate it.
- One concrete sales play, with a two-to-three sentence justification tied to your insights.

Summary

Congratulations! You have completed a focused market analysis and turned it into a decision. The skill you practiced here, moving from research to insight to action, is what separates sellers who use data from those who merely collect it. Compare your work to the Lab 2.1 Exemplar Solution to observe one strong approach.
